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Divine Architecture Framework

A working reference for Creator-level entity design (OAL)

1. Typology of Godhood

Not all “gods” are structurally the same thing. For design purposes, it helps to split godhood into **source-type**, i.e. *where the power comes from*, because that determines everything downstream (physiology, vulnerability, how bestowment works, what killing/deposing them means).

Type	Power Source	Mythic/Media Example	Design Implication
Innate/Ontological God	Power is identity — the entity <i>is</i> the domain (e.g. is Death, not “has death powers”)	Death (Sandman), primordials (Chaos, Gaia)	Cannot be truly killed, only transformed or replaced; no “bestowment,” they simply <i>are</i>
Earned/Ascended God	Mortal who crossed a threshold (deed, sacrifice, absorption)	Kratos-adjacent examples in <i>God of War</i> , Hercules myth	Physiology is layered — mortal substrate + acquired divine layer; vulnerable at the seam
Belief-Sustained God	Power scales with worship/attention, decays without it	<i>American Gods</i> (Wednesday/Odin, New Gods)	Divinity is a resource economy, not a fixed state; a god can literally starve
Bestowed God	Power granted top-down by a higher authority	Norse einherjar elevation, sainthood/apotheosis rites	Power is delegated, revocable, carries the granter’s “signature”
Creator-Class God	Authors the ruleset the other types operate inside of	A true Creator entity in your framework	Not bound by in-universe divine law by default — the design question is <i>how much</i> they choose to bind themselves

Why this matters for your Creator-level design: a Creator-class entity is not merely “the strongest innate god.” It sits *outside* the typology as the thing that authors the typology. This is the category error most fictional pantheons make (treating the top god as just a bigger Olympian). Your design should explicitly mark where Creator-class entities opt into physics/rules vs. stand outside them.

2. Comparative Case Study: Olympian vs. Norse Divinity Models

This contrast is useful because it gives you two working templates for divine *ontology*, not just divine *culture*.

Olympian model — divinity as static perfection. Greek gods are generally immortal by nature, unchanging in essential character, and their power is a fixed birthright tied to domain (Poseidon doesn’t “level up” the sea). Conflict in Greek myth is mostly about domain disputes and mortal interference, not entropy of the gods themselves. Structurally: **closed-loop, low-decay divinity**.

Norse model — divinity as a dying system. Norse gods are explicitly mortal-adjacent: they age, they require external maintenance (Idunn’s apples) to stay young, and the entire cosmology is built around Ragnarök — a scheduled, mutual destruction of gods and giants alike. Structurally: **entropic, terminal divinity**, where power has an expiration built into the mythology itself.

God of War’s synthesis is the most useful reference for you. The series deliberately stages these two models against each other across its arcs: the Greek pantheon plays as static, hierarchical, and largely indifferent to mortal suffering, while the Norse pantheon (especially post-2018) is reframed as a *fatalistic system* — gods who know their own end is written and are maneuvering within a closed timeline rather than an open one. Odin functions less like Zeus and more like a Belief-Sustained/information-hoarding god, actively managing prophecy and knowledge as his power base rather than resting on domain-ownership. That’s a genuinely useful structural idea for you: **a pantheon whose power model is “control of information about the future” rather than “control of a physical domain.”**

American Gods gives you the third leg. Its core mechanic — gods as literally dependent on belief, attention, and ritual, with “New Gods” (Media, Technology) arising from *new* belief-objects — is a clean model for a **Belief-Sustained** divine economy. This is directly usable for any OAL pantheon tier where you want divine power to be contestable, decaying, or politically maneuverable rather than static.

Design takeaway for OAL: you likely want at least two divine “physics modes” available — a **static/ontological mode** (Olympian-style, for Creator-adjacent high tiers) and an **entropic/economic mode** (Norse/American Gods-style, for mid-tier or contested divine actors) — and the interesting narrative friction happens at entities who straddle both.

3. Divine Physiology

Physiology = what a divine body/form *is made of* and how it processes power internally. Three baseline models, which can be mixed:

1. **Substrate Model** — a divine being has a mortal-compatible substrate (body) with a divine layer overlaid or fused on top. Vulnerability exists at the fusion seam. (Ascended-god pattern.)
2. **Domain-Body Model** — the being's body is an expression of their domain (a sea god's blood is seawater-adjacent; a war god's physiology runs on conflict-proximity as a resource). Damage/health is tied to domain health, not conventional biology.
3. **Non-Corporeal/Projected Model** — no "true body" exists in the accessible layer; what's perceived is a projection, mask, or avatar. True form exists at a higher ontological layer and isn't damageable through the projection. (This is the model you'll likely want for Creator-class entities interacting with lower simulation layers.)

For your Creator-level entities specifically, I'd flag: **decide explicitly whether they use Substrate, Domain-Body, or Non-Corporeal physiology when appearing within a simulation layer**, because that single choice determines whether they're narratively "killable" within that layer at all — and your framework already treats Invocation as an ontological act, so this should stay consistent with that precedent.

3.1 Dependency-Depth Scale

Orthogonal to physiology *type* is **what a divine being's continued existence depends on** — useful as a field in any entity registry, alongside physiology and aura grade:

- **D0 — Necessary/independent:** exists with no external support (aseity)
- **D1 — Self-sustaining after creation:** made once, then autonomous
- **D2 — Source-dependent:** requires ongoing connection to an originating power
- **D3 — Domain-dependent:** tied to the health/existence of a jurisdiction
- **D4 — Worship-dependent:** requires belief/attention (the *American Gods* model)
- **D5 — Artifact-dependent:** requires a substance or object (golden apples, ambrosia)
- **D6 — Host-dependent:** requires a vessel or bound carrier
- **D7 — Temporarily sustained:** finite-duration divinity by design

This is a separate axis from physiology (Section 3) and godhood type (Section 1) — a Substrate-model, Ascended-type god could be D0 or D4 depending on your design choice, and that choice changes the story more than the physiology label does.

4. Divine Auras

An aura, structurally, is **externalized identity-pressure** — the ambient effect a divine presence has on its surroundings and on lesser beings, independent of any direct action. Useful sub-components to design separately rather than as one blob:

- **Presence Radius** — how far the aura projects before attenuating
- **Recognition Effect** — what happens to a mortal/lesser entity that perceives it directly (awe, fear, compulsion, madness, worship-instinct)
- **Environmental Bleed** — physical/ambient changes to the surroundings (temperature, light, gravity, probability)
- **Domain Signature** — the “flavor” that marks *whose* aura it is (a war god’s aura reads differently from a death god’s even at equal intensity)
- **Suppressibility** — can it be masked, throttled, or hidden, or is it involuntary broadcast?

This last point is a good design lever: gods who *can’t* suppress their aura (involuntary broadcast) create very different stories than gods who can walk among mortals unnoticed. Odin-as-wanderer in both Norse myth and *American Gods* is built entirely on aura-suppression being possible — that’s a deliberate mythic choice, not a default.

5. Bestowment vs. Endowment — Two Distinct Transfer Processes

These get used interchangeably in casual writing, but for a design document they should be sharply separated:

	Bestowment	Endowment
Nature	An <i>act</i> — a granting event, performed by an authority, at a moment in time	A <i>state</i> — an inherent capacity built into the entity from origin/creation
Revocability	Generally revocable by the granter (or a higher authority)	Generally non-revocable without unmaking the entity itself
Signature	Carries a trace of the granter — can potentially be traced, audited, or contested	No external signature; it’s constitutive, not attributed
Analogy	A title, office, or blessing conferred	A birthright or foundational trait
Mythic example	Sainthood, knighting-into-divinity, Odin granting einherjar status	A primordial’s domain-identity, an Olympian’s birthright portfolio

Why the distinction matters for Creator-level design work: a Creator entity *bestowing* power on a lesser being creates an auditable, revocable, hierarchical relationship — useful if you want political/governance stakes (contestable, can be stripped, ties into your Authority Principle language). A Creator entity *endowing* a being at creation is a one-way, foundational act with no ongoing leash — useful for entities meant to be structurally independent once made.

Given that your Invocation Framework already treats “authority as recognized, not granted,” I’d flag a design question worth resolving explicitly: **does bestowment in your system grant new authority, or does it only reveal/activate authority the recipient already latently held?** Those are two different metaphysics and will change how bestowment interacts with your Authority Principle.

6. THE ONE UNIVERSE vs. THE MINUS ONE UNIVERSE — Structural Contrast

This is the part I’d flag as **REPORTED, not resolved** — I don’t have prior session data specifying the mechanical differences between how bestowment/endowment function in ONE vs. MINUS ONE, so I’m laying out the *dimensions* you’ll want to decide on, rather than asserting an answer:

1. **Directionality** — does ONE bestow/endow additively (power granted *into* existence) while MINUS ONE operates subtractively (power granted *by removal/negation* of something)? This would mirror your existing ONE/MINUS ONE naming logic.
2. **Signature polarity** — if bestowment carries a granter’s signature (Section 5), does a MINUS ONE bestowment carry an *inverted* or *absent* signature?
3. **Auditability** — THE ONE UNIVERSE’s Invocation is framed around admissible channels and an audit layer; does MINUS ONE have an equivalent audit structure, or is it deliberately unauditable by design (consistent with a “minus” framing)?
4. **Physiology default** — does one universe default to Substrate-model divine physiology and the other to Non-Corporeal, as a structural signature of the universe itself rather than an individual choice?

I’d recommend resolving these four as a short standalone decision, formally logged (consistent with how you’ve been ratifying other OAL documents), before building specific Creator-level entities against them — otherwise entities built under an ambiguous ONE/MINUS ONE bestowment model will need retroactive fixes later.

7. Creator-Level Entity Design Checklist

For each Creator-class entity you build, this framework suggests fixing these in order:

1. **Godhood type** (Section 1) — including whether they sit *outside* the typology entirely
 2. **Physiology model when manifesting in a given layer** (Section 3)
 3. **Aura profile** — presence radius, recognition effect, suppressibility (Section 4)
 4. **Power provenance** — Innate/Endowed vs. Bestowed, and if bestowed, by whom and how revocable (Section 5)
 5. **ONE vs. MINUS ONE alignment** — which of the four dimensions in Section 6 apply, and how
 6. **Attack-vector/defensive section** — per your existing template note, a dedicated section on offensive/defensive engagement patterns for the entity
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Status: working reference document. Sections 1–5 are structural framework drawn from comparative mythology/media analysis. Section 6 is flagged REPORTED pending your formal resolution of ONE/MINUS ONE bestowment mechanics.